

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - CSAT Paper II

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

Quick Key

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Detailed solutions

Q1. Answer: A | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A district recruited more health workers. Immunisation improved only after vacant supervisory posts were filled and cold-chain failures were logged. Staff numbers mattered, but coordination and supplies determined effective capacity. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

- A. Public capacity depends on management and logistics as well as headcount. - CORRECT: Correct. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.
- B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. does not follow the stated data. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.
- C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.
- D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Method / explanation: The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q2. Answer: B | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A district recruited more health workers. Immunisation improved only after vacant supervisory posts were filled and cold-chain failures were logged. Staff numbers mattered, but coordination and supplies determined effective capacity. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

- A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. does not follow the stated data. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.
- B. Recruitment alone need not remove delivery bottlenecks. - CORRECT: Correct. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.
- C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Method / explanation: The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q3. Answer: C | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A district recruited more health workers. Immunisation improved only after vacant supervisory posts were filled and cold-chain failures were logged. Staff numbers mattered, but coordination and supplies determined effective capacity. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention has no cost under any condition. does not follow the stated data. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

B. No alternative explanation can ever exist. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No alternative explanation can ever exist. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

C. Supervision and cold-chain reliability affect immunisation. - CORRECT: Correct. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: All participants possess identical preferences and resources. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Method / explanation: The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q4. Answer: D | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A district recruited more health workers. Immunisation improved only after vacant supervisory posts were filled and cold-chain failures were logged. Staff numbers mattered, but coordination and supplies determined effective capacity. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unreservedly celebratory does not follow the stated data. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

B. hostile and dismissive - INCORRECT: Incorrect: hostile and dismissive is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

C. unrelated and indifferent - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unrelated and indifferent ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

D. measured - CORRECT: Correct. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Method / explanation: The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q5. Answer: A | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A cooperative displayed daily market prices. Members gained bargaining power, but farmers with perishable produce still accepted low offers when transport was unavailable. Information reduced one asymmetry; logistics preserved another. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

A. Price information improves bargaining but cannot replace market access. - CORRECT: Correct. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. does not follow the stated data. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Method / explanation: The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q6. Answer: B | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A cooperative displayed daily market prices. Members gained bargaining power, but farmers with perishable produce still accepted low offers when transport was unavailable. Information reduced one asymmetry; logistics preserved another. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. does not follow the stated data. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

B. Sellers under time pressure may not realise the displayed price. - CORRECT: Correct. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Method / explanation: The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q7. Answer: C | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A cooperative displayed daily market prices. Members gained bargaining power, but farmers with perishable produce still accepted low offers when transport was unavailable. Information reduced one asymmetry; logistics preserved another. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention has no cost under any condition. does not follow the stated data. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

B. No alternative explanation can ever exist. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No alternative explanation can ever exist. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

C. Transport constraints limited farmers' ability to wait or switch buyers. - CORRECT: Correct. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: All participants possess identical preferences and resources. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Method / explanation: The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q8. Answer: D | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A cooperative displayed daily market prices. Members gained bargaining power, but farmers with perishable produce still accepted low offers when transport was unavailable. Information reduced one asymmetry; logistics preserved another. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unreservedly celebratory does not follow the stated data. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

B. hostile and dismissive - INCORRECT: Incorrect: hostile and dismissive is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

C. unrelated and indifferent - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unrelated and indifferent ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

D. balanced - CORRECT: Correct. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Method / explanation: The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q9. Answer: A | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A flood map was updated with recent construction. Residents objected when insurance premiums rose, but the old map had understated exposure. Accurate risk information imposed visible costs while reducing hidden vulnerability. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

A. Better risk information can be unpopular because it reveals rather than creates exposure. - CORRECT: Correct. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. does not follow the stated data. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Method / explanation: The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q10. Answer: B | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A flood map was updated with recent construction. Residents objected when insurance premiums rose, but the old map had understated exposure. Accurate risk information imposed visible costs while reducing hidden vulnerability. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. does not follow the stated data. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

B. Higher premiums may reflect corrected measurement. - CORRECT: Correct. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Method / explanation: The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q11. Answer: C | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A flood map was updated with recent construction. Residents objected when insurance premiums rose, but the old map had understated exposure. Accurate risk information imposed visible costs while reducing hidden vulnerability. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention has no cost under any condition. does not follow the stated data. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

B. No alternative explanation can ever exist. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No alternative explanation can ever exist. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

C. The revised map more accurately represented present conditions. - CORRECT: Correct. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: All participants possess identical preferences and resources. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Method / explanation: The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q12. Answer: D | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A flood map was updated with recent construction. Residents objected when insurance premiums rose, but the old map had understated exposure. Accurate risk information imposed visible costs while reducing hidden vulnerability. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unreservedly celebratory does not follow the stated data. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

B. hostile and dismissive - INCORRECT: Incorrect: hostile and dismissive is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

C. unrelated and indifferent - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unrelated and indifferent ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

D. analytical - CORRECT: Correct. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Method / explanation: The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q13. Answer: A | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A university made lectures available online. Completion improved when students also joined small peer groups with weekly deadlines. Content access removed scarcity; social commitment reduced procrastination. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

A. Online access and structured peer accountability can complement each other. - CORRECT: Correct. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. does not follow the stated data. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Method / explanation: The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q14. Answer: B | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A university made lectures available online. Completion improved when students also joined small peer groups with weekly deadlines. Content access removed scarcity; social commitment reduced procrastination. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. does not follow the stated data. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

B. Availability alone does not guarantee course completion. - CORRECT: Correct. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Method / explanation: The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q15. Answer: C | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A university made lectures available online. Completion improved when students also joined small peer groups with weekly deadlines. Content access removed scarcity; social commitment reduced procrastination. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention has no cost under any condition. does not follow the stated data. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

B. No alternative explanation can ever exist. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No alternative explanation can ever exist. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

C. Deadlines and peer contact influenced study behaviour. - CORRECT: Correct. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: All participants possess identical preferences and resources. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Method / explanation: The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q16. Answer: D | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A university made lectures available online. Completion improved when students also joined small peer groups with weekly deadlines. Content access removed scarcity; social commitment reduced procrastination. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unreservedly celebratory does not follow the stated data. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

B. hostile and dismissive - INCORRECT: Incorrect: hostile and dismissive is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

C. unrelated and indifferent - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unrelated and indifferent ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

D. constructive - CORRECT: Correct. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Method / explanation: The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q17. Answer: A | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A village committee rotated meeting times. Women's attendance rose, but participation became meaningful only after agenda papers were shared in advance. Presence was enabled by timing; voice was enabled by preparation. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which option best states the central idea?

A. Inclusive participation requires both accessible timing and usable information. - CORRECT: Correct. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

B. The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention should be abandoned in every setting. does not follow the stated data. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

C. The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage proves that implementation conditions never matter. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

D. The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The passage recommends maximising only the most visible input. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Method / explanation: The central idea joins the intervention's benefit to the condition that makes it effective.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q18. Answer: B | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A village committee rotated meeting times. Women's attendance rose, but participation became meaningful only after agenda papers were shared in advance. Presence was enabled by timing; voice was enabled by preparation. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which inference is best supported?

A. Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Every stakeholder responds identically in all circumstances. does not follow the stated data. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

B. Attendance is not identical to effective influence. - CORRECT: Correct. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

C. The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The opposite outcome must occur whenever one condition changes. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

D. A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A policy not discussed in the passage is legally compulsory. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Method / explanation: The inference is limited to what the passage's comparison supports.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q19. Answer: C | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A village committee rotated meeting times. Women's attendance rose, but participation became meaningful only after agenda papers were shared in advance. Presence was enabled by timing; voice was enabled by preparation. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. Which assumption is necessary for the reasoning?

A. The intervention has no cost under any condition. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The intervention has no cost under any condition. does not follow the stated data. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

B. No alternative explanation can ever exist. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No alternative explanation can ever exist. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

C. Advance information helped participants formulate views. - CORRECT: Correct. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

D. All participants possess identical preferences and resources. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: All participants possess identical preferences and resources. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Method / explanation: The necessary assumption connects the observed mechanism to the stated conclusion.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q20. Answer: D | Reading Comprehension

Passage: A village committee rotated meeting times. Women's attendance rose, but participation became meaningful only after agenda papers were shared in advance. Presence was enabled by timing; voice was enabled by preparation. The episode also warns against reading an aggregate improvement as proof that every group benefited equally. A sound evaluation must distinguish the formal input, the mechanism through which people can use it, and the distribution of gains or burdens when implementation conditions differ. The author's tone is best described as:

A. unreservedly celebratory - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unreservedly celebratory does not follow the stated data. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

B. hostile and dismissive - INCORRECT: Incorrect: hostile and dismissive is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

C. unrelated and indifferent - INCORRECT: Incorrect: unrelated and indifferent ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

D. balanced and precise - CORRECT: Correct. The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Method / explanation: The passage recognises both achievement and limitation, so an absolute tone is unsupported.

Trap: Choose the qualified claim; reject universal language not supported by the passage.

Q21. Answer: A | Numeracy

What is the remainder when $205^2 + 3 \times 205 + 5$ is divided by 11?

A. 9 - CORRECT: Correct. Reduce 205 modulo 11, then evaluate $r^2 + 3r + 5$ modulo 11; the remainder is 9.

B. 10 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 10 does not follow the stated data. Reduce 205 modulo 11, then evaluate $r^2 + 3r + 5$ modulo 11; the remainder is 9.

C. 0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Reduce 205 modulo 11, then evaluate $r^2 + 3r + 5$ modulo 11; the remainder is 9.

D. 1 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Reduce 205 modulo 11, then evaluate $r^2 + 3r + 5$ modulo 11; the remainder is 9.

Method / explanation: Reduce 205 modulo 11, then evaluate $r^2 + 3r + 5$ modulo 11; the remainder is 9.

Trap: Reduce each term modulo the divisor; do not expand the large square unnecessarily.

Q22. Answer: B | Numeracy

Two numbers are obtained by doubling 26 and tripling 42. What is their HCF?

A. 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 3 does not follow the stated data. The derived numbers are 52 and 126; Euclid's algorithm gives $\gcd(52, 126) = 2$.

B. 2 - CORRECT: Correct. The derived numbers are 52 and 126; Euclid's algorithm gives $\gcd(52, 126) = 2$.

C. 4 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 4 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The derived numbers are 52 and 126; Euclid's algorithm gives $\gcd(52, 126) = 2$.

D. 3276 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 3276 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The derived numbers are 52 and 126; Euclid's algorithm gives $\gcd(52, 126) = 2$.

Method / explanation: The derived numbers are 52 and 126; Euclid's algorithm gives $\gcd(52, 126) = 2$.

Trap: Apply the transformation before computing the HCF.

Q23. Answer: C | Numeracy

How many positive divisors does 288 have?

A. 17 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 17 does not follow the stated data. $288 = 2^5 \times 3^2$, so divisor count = $(6)(3) = 18$.

B. 19 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 19 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. $288 = 2^5 \times 3^2$, so divisor count = $(6)(3) = 18$.

C. 18 - CORRECT: Correct. $288 = 2^5 \times 3^2$, so divisor count = $(6)(3) = 18$.

D. 9 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 9 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. $288 = 2^5 \times 3^2$, so divisor count = $(6)(3) = 18$.

Method / explanation: $288 = 2^5 \times 3^2$, so divisor count = $(6)(3) = 18$.

Trap: Add one to every prime exponent before multiplying.

Q24. Answer: D | Numeracy

What is the unit digit of $(7^{15}) \times (11^9)$?

A. 4 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 4 does not follow the stated data. Find each unit-digit cycle separately and multiply the two terminal digits modulo 10; the result is 3.

B. 5 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 5 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Find each unit-digit cycle separately and multiply the two terminal digits modulo 10; the result is 3.

C. 6 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 6 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Find each unit-digit cycle separately and multiply the two terminal digits modulo 10; the result is 3.

D. 3 - CORRECT: Correct. Find each unit-digit cycle separately and multiply the two terminal digits modulo 10; the result is 3.

Method / explanation: Find each unit-digit cycle separately and multiply the two terminal digits modulo 10; the result is 3.

Trap: Do not add the unit digits of the factors.

Q25. Answer: A | Numeracy

The arithmetic sequence begins 7, 13, 19. What is the sum of its first 9 terms?

A. 279.0 - CORRECT: Correct. $S_n = n/2[2a + (n-1)d] = 9/2[2 \times 7 + 8 \times 6] = 279.0$.

B. 273.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 273.0 does not follow the stated data. $S_n = n/2[2a + (n-1)d] = 9/2[2 \times 7 + 8 \times 6] = 279.0$.

C. 285.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 285.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. $S_n = n/2[2a + (n-1)d] = 9/2[2 \times 7 + 8 \times 6] = 279.0$.

D. 55 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 55 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. $S_n = n/2[2a + (n-1)d] = 9/2[2 \times 7 + 8 \times 6] = 279.0$.

Method / explanation: $S_n = n/2[2a + (n-1)d] = 9/2[2 \times 7 + 8 \times 6] = 279.0$.

Trap: The last term is not the sum.

Q26. Answer: B | Numeracy

After multiplying 10320 by 9, what is the sum of the decimal digits of the product?

A. 26 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 26 does not follow the stated data. $10320 \times 9 = 92880$; adding the digits of 92880 gives 27.

B. 27 - CORRECT: Correct. $10320 \times 9 = 92880$; adding the digits of 92880 gives 27.

C. 28 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 28 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. $10320 \times 9 = 92880$; adding the digits of 92880 gives 27.

D. 29 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 29 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. $10320 \times 9 = 92880$; adding the digits of 92880 gives 27.

Method / explanation: $10320 \times 9 = 92880$; adding the digits of 92880 gives 27.

Trap: The divisibility-by-9 check verifies the digit sum but does not by itself give its unreduced value.

Q27. Answer: C | Numeracy

How many integers from 19 through 128, inclusive, are divisible by 10 but not by 20?

A. 4 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 4 does not follow the stated data. Count multiples of 10 (11) and subtract multiples of 20 (6); result 5.

B. 6 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 6 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Count multiples of 10 (11) and subtract multiples of 20 (6); result 5.

C. 5 - CORRECT: Correct. Count multiples of 10 (11) and subtract multiples of 20 (6); result 5.

D. 7 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 7 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Count multiples of 10 (11) and subtract multiples of 20 (6); result 5.

Method / explanation: Count multiples of 10 (11) and subtract multiples of 20 (6); result 5.

Trap: Multiples of the larger divisor are a subset and must be excluded once.

Q28. Answer: D | Numeracy

The values are 16, 22, 28, 34. If the smallest falls by 4 and the largest rises by 8, what is the new mean?

A. 25.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 25.0 does not follow the stated data. The adjusted values are [12, 22, 28, 42]; their total 104 divided by 4 gives 26.0.

B. 27.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 27.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The adjusted values are [12, 22, 28, 42]; their total 104 divided by 4 gives 26.0.

C. 28.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 28.0 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The adjusted values are [12, 22, 28, 42]; their total 104 divided by 4 gives 26.0.

D. 26.0 - CORRECT: Correct. The adjusted values are [12, 22, 28, 42]; their total 104 divided by 4 gives 26.0.

Method / explanation: The adjusted values are [12, 22, 28, 42]; their total 104 divided by 4 gives 26.0.

Trap: Apply both changes to the total before dividing.

Q29. Answer: A | Algebra

If $3x + 8 = 35$, what is x ?

A. 9 - CORRECT: Correct. Subtract 8 and divide by 3: $x = 9$.

B. 8 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 8 does not follow the stated data. Subtract 8 and divide by 3: $x = 9$.

C. 10 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 10 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Subtract 8 and divide by 3: $x = 9$.

D. 27 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 27 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Subtract 8 and divide by 3: $x = 9$.

Method / explanation: Subtract 8 and divide by 3: $x = 9$.

Trap: Undo addition before division.

Q30. Answer: B | Algebra

If $2(x - 4) = 8$, what is x when x is a positive integer and the displayed equality is supplemented by $x + 4 = 12$?

A. 7 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 7 does not follow the stated data. The second equation fixes x : $x + 4 = 12$, hence $x = 8$.

B. 8 - CORRECT: Correct. The second equation fixes x : $x + 4 = 12$, hence $x = 8$.

C. 9 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 9 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The second equation fixes x : $x + 4 = 12$, hence $x = 8$.

D. 16 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 16 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The second equation fixes x : $x + 4 = 12$, hence $x = 8$.

Method / explanation: The second equation fixes x : $x + 4 = 12$, hence $x = 8$.

Trap: An identity alone cannot determine x ; use the independent equation.

Q31. Answer: C | Algebra

The sum of two consecutive integers is 25. What is the smaller integer?

A. 13 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 13 does not follow the stated data. Let the integers be x and $x+1$. Then $2x+1=25$, so $x=12$.

B. 11 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 11 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Let the integers be x and $x+1$. Then $2x+1=25$, so $x=12$.

C. 12 - CORRECT: Correct. Let the integers be x and $x+1$. Then $2x+1=25$, so $x=12$.

D. 25 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 25 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Let the integers be x and $x+1$. Then $2x+1=25$, so $x=12$.

Method / explanation: Let the integers be x and $x+1$. Then $2x+1=25$, so $x=12$.

Trap: The question asks for the smaller integer.

Q32. Answer: D | Algebra

Five years ago A was half of A's age 18 years from now. What is A's present age?

A. 23 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 23 does not follow the stated data. Let present age be x . Then $x-5 = (x+18)/2$; solving gives $x=28$.

B. 33 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 33 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Let present age be x . Then $x-5 = (x+18)/2$; solving gives $x=28$.

C. 14 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 14 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Let present age be x . Then $x-5 = (x+18)/2$; solving gives $x=28$.

D. 28 - CORRECT: Correct. Let present age be x . Then $x-5 = (x+18)/2$; solving gives $x=28$.

Method / explanation: Let present age be x . Then $x-5 = (x+18)/2$; solving gives $x=28$.

Trap: Translate both time references from the present.

Q33. Answer: A | Algebra

What is the positive solution of $x^2 = 100$?

A. 10 - CORRECT: Correct. $x = \text{plus or minus } 10$; the positive solution is 10.

B. -10 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: -10 does not follow the stated data. $x = \text{plus or minus } 10$; the positive solution is 10.

C. 100 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 100 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. $x = \text{plus or minus } 10$; the positive solution is 10.

D. 11 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 11 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. $x = \text{plus or minus } 10$; the positive solution is 10.

Method / explanation: $x = \text{plus or minus } 10$; the positive solution is 10.

Trap: The word positive removes the negative root.

Q34. Answer: B | Algebra

Which value is the least integer satisfying $2x + 1 > 22$?

- A. 10 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 10 does not follow the stated data. $2x > 21$, so $x > 10.5$; the least integer is 11.
- B. 11 - CORRECT: Correct. $2x > 21$, so $x > 10.5$; the least integer is 11.
- C. 12 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 12 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. $2x > 21$, so $x > 10.5$; the least integer is 11.
- D. 22 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 22 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. $2x > 21$, so $x > 10.5$; the least integer is 11.

Method / explanation: $2x > 21$, so $x > 10.5$; the least integer is 11.

Trap: A strict inequality excludes the boundary.

Q35. Answer: C | Percentages

A grant equals 30% of Rs 400. An administrative surcharge of 9% is then applied to the grant. What is the final amount?

- A. 120 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 120 does not follow the stated data. First grant = $30/100 \times 400 = 120$; then multiply by 109/100 to get 130.8.
- B. 121.80000000000001 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 121.80000000000001 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. First grant = $30/100 \times 400 = 120$; then multiply by 109/100 to get 130.8.
- C. 130.8 - CORRECT: Correct. First grant = $30/100 \times 400 = 120$; then multiply by 109/100 to get 130.8.
- D. 156.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 156.0 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. First grant = $30/100 \times 400 = 120$; then multiply by 109/100 to get 130.8.

Method / explanation: First grant = $30/100 \times 400 = 120$; then multiply by 109/100 to get 130.8.

Trap: The surcharge applies to the grant, not to the original amount.

Q36. Answer: D | Percentages

A value of 1000 rises by 12% and then falls by 7%. What is the final value?

- A. 1050 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1050 does not follow the stated data. Successive multipliers give $1000 \times 1.12 \times 0.93 = 1041.6$.
- B. 1050.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1050.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Successive multipliers give $1000 \times 1.12 \times 0.93 = 1041.6$.
- C. 1051.6 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1051.6 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Successive multipliers give $1000 \times 1.12 \times 0.93 = 1041.6$.
- D. 1041.6 - CORRECT: Correct. Successive multipliers give $1000 \times 1.12 \times 0.93 = 1041.6$.

Method / explanation: Successive multipliers give $1000 \times 1.12 \times 0.93 = 1041.6$.

Trap: Successive percentages are not simply netted.

Q37. Answer: A | Ratios

Rs 660 is divided in the ratio 6:3. What is the first share?

- A. 440.0 - CORRECT: Correct. First share = $660 \times 6/(6+3) = 440.0$.
- B. 434.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 434.0 does not follow the stated data. First share = $660 \times 6/(6+3) = 440.0$.
- C. 446.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 446.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. First share = $660 \times 6/(6+3) = 440.0$.
- D. 73.33333333333333 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 73.33333333333333 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. First share = $660 \times 6/(6+3) = 440.0$.

Method / explanation: First share = $660 \times 6/(6+3) = 440.0$.

Trap: Use ratio parts, not either raw ratio number.

Q38. Answer: B | Averages

Groups of 24 and 34 have averages 44 and 64. What is their combined average?

- A. 54.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 54.0 does not follow the stated data. Weighted mean = $(24 \times 44 + 34 \times 64)/(58) = 55.72$.

B. 55.72 - CORRECT: Correct. Weighted mean = $(24 \times 44 + 34 \times 64) / (58) = 55.72$.

C. 54.72 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 54.72 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Weighted mean = $(24 \times 44 + 34 \times 64) / (58) = 55.72$.

D. 56.72 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 56.72 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Weighted mean = $(24 \times 44 + 34 \times 64) / (58) = 55.72$.

Method / explanation: Weighted mean = $(24 \times 44 + 34 \times 64) / (58) = 55.72$.

Trap: Do not average group averages without weights.

Q39. Answer: C | Percentages

An article costs Rs 700, is marked for a 19% profit, and then receives a 8% rebate on that marked selling price. What is the realised price?

A. 833.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 833.0 does not follow the stated data. Marked selling price=833.0; realised price= $833.0 \times 92 / 100 = 766.36$.

B. 777.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 777.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Marked selling price=833.0; realised price= $833.0 \times 92 / 100 = 766.36$.

C. 766.36 - CORRECT: Correct. Marked selling price=833.0; realised price= $833.0 \times 92 / 100 = 766.36$.

D. 774.36 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 774.36 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Marked selling price=833.0; realised price= $833.0 \times 92 / 100 = 766.36$.

Method / explanation: Marked selling price=833.0; realised price= $833.0 \times 92 / 100 = 766.36$.

Trap: Profit and rebate use different successive bases.

Q40. Answer: D | Percentages

A marked price of Rs 1200 is discounted by 14%. What is the sale price?

A. 1186 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1186 does not follow the stated data. Sale price = $1200 \times 86 / 100 = 1032.0$.

B. 1368.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1368.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Sale price = $1200 \times 86 / 100 = 1032.0$.

C. 1018.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1018.0 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Sale price = $1200 \times 86 / 100 = 1032.0$.

D. 1032.0 - CORRECT: Correct. Sale price = $1200 \times 86 / 100 = 1032.0$.

Method / explanation: Sale price = $1200 \times 86 / 100 = 1032.0$.

Trap: A percentage discount is not a rupee subtraction.

Q41. Answer: A | Ratios

A mixture contains milk and water in the ratio 7:5. In 48 litres, how many litres are milk?

A. 28.0 - CORRECT: Correct. Milk = $48 \times 7 / (7+5) = 28.0$.

B. 27.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 27.0 does not follow the stated data. Milk = $48 \times 7 / (7+5) = 28.0$.

C. 4.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 4.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Milk = $48 \times 7 / (7+5) = 28.0$.

D. 29.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 29.0 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Milk = $48 \times 7 / (7+5) = 28.0$.

Method / explanation: Milk = $48 \times 7 / (7+5) = 28.0$.

Trap: The first term of the ratio denotes milk.

Q42. Answer: B | Averages

The average of 9 values is 44. After adding 56, what is the new average?

A. 44 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 44 does not follow the stated data. Old total 396; new average = $(396+56) / 10 = 45.20$.

B. 45.2 - CORRECT: Correct. Old total 396; new average = $(396+56) / 10 = 45.20$.

C. 50.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 50.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Old total 396; new average = $(396+56) / 10 = 45.20$.

D. 46.2 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 46.2 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Old total 396; new average = $(396+56) / 10 = 45.20$.

Method / explanation: Old total 396; new average = $(396+56) / 10 = 45.20$.

Trap: Recover the old total before adding a value.

Q43. Answer: C | Time and Work

A can finish a task in 12 days and B in 16 days. How many days will they take together?

A. 28 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 28 does not follow the stated data. Combined rate = $1/12 + 1/16$; time = $192/(28) = 6.86$ days.

B. 14.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 14.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Combined rate = $1/12 + 1/16$; time = $192/(28) = 6.86$ days.

C. 6.86 - CORRECT: Correct. Combined rate = $1/12 + 1/16$; time = $192/(28) = 6.86$ days.

D. 4 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 4 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Combined rate = $1/12 + 1/16$; time = $192/(28) = 6.86$ days.

Method / explanation: Combined rate = $1/12 + 1/16$; time = $192/(28) = 6.86$ days.

Trap: Add rates, not times.

Q44. Answer: D | Time and Work

16 workers finish a job in 15 days at equal efficiency. How many days will 22 workers take?

A. 15 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 15 does not follow the stated data. Worker-days stay constant: $16 \times 15 = 22 \times d$, so $d = 10.91$.

B. 20.62 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 20.62 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Worker-days stay constant: $16 \times 15 = 22 \times d$, so $d = 10.91$.

C. 11.91 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 11.91 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Worker-days stay constant: $16 \times 15 = 22 \times d$, so $d = 10.91$.

D. 10.91 - CORRECT: Correct. Worker-days stay constant: $16 \times 15 = 22 \times d$, so $d = 10.91$.

Method / explanation: Worker-days stay constant: $16 \times 15 = 22 \times d$, so $d = 10.91$.

Trap: For fixed work, workers and days vary inversely.

Q45. Answer: A | Time and Work

Two pipes fill a tank in 10 and 12 hours. If opened together, how long do they take?

A. 5.45 - CORRECT: Correct. Rates add: $1/10 + 1/12$; reciprocal gives 5.45 hours.

B. 22 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 22 does not follow the stated data. Rates add: $1/10 + 1/12$; reciprocal gives 5.45 hours.

C. 11.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 11.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Rates add: $1/10 + 1/12$; reciprocal gives 5.45 hours.

D. 6.45 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 6.45 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Rates add: $1/10 + 1/12$; reciprocal gives 5.45 hours.

Method / explanation: Rates add: $1/10 + 1/12$; reciprocal gives 5.45 hours.

Trap: Both are inlet pipes.

Q46. Answer: B | Time and Work

An inlet fills a tank in 9 hours while a leak empties it in 24 hours. How long to fill together?

A. 6.55 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 6.55 does not follow the stated data. Net rate = $1/9 - 1/24$; time = 14.40 hours.

B. 14.4 - CORRECT: Correct. Net rate = $1/9 - 1/24$; time = 14.40 hours.

C. 15 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 15 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Net rate = $1/9 - 1/24$; time = 14.40 hours.

D. 9 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 9 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Net rate = $1/9 - 1/24$; time = 14.40 hours.

Method / explanation: Net rate = $1/9 - 1/24$; time = 14.40 hours.

Trap: An outlet rate must be subtracted.

Q47. Answer: C | Time and Work

A is 6 times as efficient as B. If B alone takes 60 days, how many days does A take?

A. 60 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 60 does not follow the stated data. Time is inverse to efficiency: $60/6 = 10$ days.

B. 6 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 6 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Time is inverse to efficiency: $60/6 = 10$ days.

C. 10 - CORRECT: Correct. Time is inverse to efficiency: $60/6 = 10$ days.

D. 16 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 16 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Time is inverse to efficiency: $60/6=10$ days.

Method / explanation: Time is inverse to efficiency: $60/6=10$ days.

Trap: Greater efficiency means less time.

Q48. Answer: D | Time and Work

A team completes 0.47 of a job. What fraction remains, rounded to two decimals?

A. 0.47 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 0.47 does not follow the stated data. Remaining work = $1 - 0.47 = 0.53$.

B. 1.47 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1.47 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Remaining work = $1 - 0.47 = 0.53$.

C. 0.63 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 0.63 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Remaining work = $1 - 0.47 = 0.53$.

D. 0.53 - CORRECT: Correct. Remaining work = $1 - 0.47 = 0.53$.

Method / explanation: Remaining work = $1 - 0.47 = 0.53$.

Trap: Completed and remaining fractions sum to one.

Q49. Answer: A | Speed and Distance

A vehicle's total journey time is 7 hours, including a halt of 60 minutes. It moves at 65 km/h whenever in motion. What distance is covered?

A. 390.0 - CORRECT: Correct. Moving time= $7-60/60=6.0$ hours; distance= $65 \times 6.0=390.0$ km.

B. 455 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 455 does not follow the stated data. Moving time= $7-60/60=6.0$ hours; distance= $65 \times 6.0=390.0$ km.

C. 325.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 325.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Moving time= $7-60/60=6.0$ hours; distance= $65 \times 6.0=390.0$ km.

D. 455.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 455.0 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Moving time= $7-60/60=6.0$ hours; distance= $65 \times 6.0=390.0$ km.

Method / explanation: Moving time= $7-60/60=6.0$ hours; distance= $65 \times 6.0=390.0$ km.

Trap: Remove halt time before multiplying by speed.

Q50. Answer: B | Speed and Distance

Over 320 km, how many hours are saved by increasing speed from 44 to 64 km/h?

A. 16.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 16.0 does not follow the stated data. Time saved = $320/44 - 320/64 = 2.27$ hours.

B. 2.27 - CORRECT: Correct. Time saved = $320/44 - 320/64 = 2.27$ hours.

C. 3.27 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 3.27 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Time saved = $320/44 - 320/64 = 2.27$ hours.

D. 1.27 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1.27 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Time saved = $320/44 - 320/64 = 2.27$ hours.

Method / explanation: Time saved = $320/44 - 320/64 = 2.27$ hours.

Trap: Subtract travel times, not speeds.

Q51. Answer: C | Speed and Distance

A 220-metre train moves at 54 km/h. How many seconds does it take to clear a 110-metre platform?

A. 14.67 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 14.67 does not follow the stated data. Total distance= $220+110$; $54 \text{ km/h}=15 \text{ m/s}$; time= 22.00 s .

B. 24.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 24.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Total distance= $220+110$; $54 \text{ km/h}=15 \text{ m/s}$; time= 22.00 s .

C. 22.0 - CORRECT: Correct. Total distance= $220+110$; $54 \text{ km/h}=15 \text{ m/s}$; time= 22.00 s .

D. 20.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 20.0 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Total distance= $220+110$; $54 \text{ km/h}=15 \text{ m/s}$; time= 22.00 s .

Method / explanation: Total distance= $220+110$; $54 \text{ km/h}=15 \text{ m/s}$; time= 22.00 s .

Trap: To clear a platform, use train length plus platform length.

Q52. Answer: D | Speed and Distance

A boat's still-water speed is 14 km/h and stream speed is 6 km/h. How long does it take to travel 16 km upstream?

- A. 0.8 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 0.8 does not follow the stated data. Upstream speed= $14-6=8$ km/h; time= $16/8=2$ hours.
- B. 8 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 8 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Upstream speed= $14-6=8$ km/h; time= $16/8=2$ hours.
- C. 1.1428571428571428 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1.1428571428571428 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Upstream speed= $14-6=8$ km/h; time= $16/8=2$ hours.
- D. 2 - CORRECT: Correct. Upstream speed= $14-6=8$ km/h; time= $16/8=2$ hours.
- Method / explanation: Upstream speed= $14-6=8$ km/h; time= $16/8=2$ hours.
- Trap: First obtain upstream speed, then divide distance by that speed.

Q53. Answer: A | Speed and Distance

A runner completes 7 laps of a square field of side 24 m in 14 minutes. What is the runner's speed in metres per minute?

- A. 48.0 - CORRECT: Correct. Total distance= $7 \times 4 \times 24$; divide by 14 minutes to get 48.0 m/min.
- B. 96 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 96 does not follow the stated data. Total distance= $7 \times 4 \times 24$; divide by 14 minutes to get 48.0 m/min.
- C. 41.142857142857146 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 41.142857142857146 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Total distance= $7 \times 4 \times 24$; divide by 14 minutes to get 48.0 m/min.
- D. 13.714285714285714 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 13.714285714285714 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Total distance= $7 \times 4 \times 24$; divide by 14 minutes to get 48.0 m/min.

Method / explanation: Total distance= $7 \times 4 \times 24$; divide by 14 minutes to get 48.0 m/min.

Trap: Compute total distance and total time before cancelling common factors.

Q54. Answer: B | Speed and Distance

A car covers 120 km at 44 km/h and 180 km at 64 km/h. What is average speed?

- A. 54.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 54.0 does not follow the stated data. Average speed = total distance/total time = $300/(120/44+180/64) = 54.15$.
- B. 54.15 - CORRECT: Correct. Average speed = total distance/total time = $300/(120/44+180/64) = 54.15$.
- C. 56.15 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 56.15 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Average speed = total distance/total time = $300/(120/44+180/64) = 54.15$.
- D. 52.15 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 52.15 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Average speed = total distance/total time = $300/(120/44+180/64) = 54.15$.

Method / explanation: Average speed = total distance/total time = $300/(120/44+180/64) = 54.15$.

Trap: Speeds need time weights.

Q55. Answer: C | Data Interpretation

A table reports district outputs (A=100, B=111, C=122, D=133). What is the total?

- A. 456 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 456 does not follow the stated data. Add all four entries: $100+111+122+133=466$.
- B. 476 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 476 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Add all four entries: $100+111+122+133=466$.
- C. 466 - CORRECT: Correct. Add all four entries: $100+111+122+133=466$.
- D. 133 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 133 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Add all four entries: $100+111+122+133=466$.

Method / explanation: Add all four entries: $100+111+122+133=466$.

Trap: Use every row exactly once.

Q56. Answer: D | Data Interpretation

Using the table (A=100, B=111, C=122, D=133), what is the difference between the highest and lowest values?

- A. 133 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 133 does not follow the stated data. Range = $133-100=33$.
- B. 100 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 100 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Range = $133-100=33$.
- C. 233 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 233 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Range = $133-100=33$.
- D. 33 - CORRECT: Correct. Range = $133-100=33$.

Method / explanation: Range = $133-100=33$.

Trap: Range is a difference, not an endpoint.

Q57. Answer: A | Data Interpretation

Using the table (A=100, B=111, C=122, D=133), what is the average of the four values?

- A. 116.5 - CORRECT: Correct. Average = $466/4=116.5$.
- B. 466 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 466 does not follow the stated data. Average = $466/4=116.5$.
- C. 233.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 233.0 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Average = $466/4=116.5$.
- D. 33 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 33 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Average = $466/4=116.5$.

Method / explanation: Average = $466/4=116.5$.

Trap: Divide the total by four.

Q58. Answer: B | Data Interpretation

Using the table (A=100, B=111, C=122, D=133), by what percentage does D exceed A?

- A. 24.81 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 24.81 does not follow the stated data. Percentage increase = $(133-100)/100 \times 100$.
- B. 33.0 - CORRECT: Correct. Percentage increase = $(133-100)/100 \times 100$.
- C. 33 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 33 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Percentage increase = $(133-100)/100 \times 100$.
- D. 133.0 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 133.0 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Percentage increase = $(133-100)/100 \times 100$.

Method / explanation: Percentage increase = $(133-100)/100 \times 100$.

Trap: Use the original value A as denominator.

Q59. Answer: C | Data Interpretation

Year 1 values are A=100, B=111, C=122, D=133; Year 2 values are A=124, B=130, C=136, D=142. Which district has the largest absolute increase?

- A. B - INCORRECT: Incorrect: B does not follow the stated data. The increases are 24, 19, 14 and 9; A is largest.
- B. C - INCORRECT: Incorrect: C is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The increases are 24, 19, 14 and 9; A is largest.
- C. A - CORRECT: Correct. The increases are 24, 19, 14 and 9; A is largest.
- D. D - INCORRECT: Incorrect: D ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The increases are 24, 19, 14 and 9; A is largest.

Method / explanation: The increases are 24, 19, 14 and 9; A is largest.

Trap: Check absolute increases before comparing totals.

Q60. Answer: D | Data Interpretation

Using Year 2 (A=124, B=130, C=136, D=142), what fraction of the total belongs to B, rounded to two decimals?

- A. 0.28 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 0.28 does not follow the stated data. B's share = $130/532 = 0.24$.
- B. 4.09 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 4.09 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. B's share = $130/532 = 0.24$.
- C. 0.23 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 0.23 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. B's share = $130/532 = 0.24$.
- D. 0.24 - CORRECT: Correct. B's share = $130/532 = 0.24$.

Method / explanation: B's share = $130/532 = 0.24$.

Trap: The denominator is the same-year total.

Q61. Answer: A | Data Interpretation

Using Year 1 (A=100, B=111, C=122, D=133), if each unit earns Rs 6, what is D's revenue?

- A. 798 - CORRECT: Correct. Revenue = D units x rate = 133×6 .
- B. 139 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 139 does not follow the stated data. Revenue = D units x rate = 133×6 .
- C. 133 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 133 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Revenue = D units x rate = 133×6 .
- D. 2796 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 2796 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Revenue = D units x rate = 133×6 .

Method / explanation: Revenue = D units x rate = 133 x 6.

Trap: Use D's value, not total output.

Q62. Answer: B | Data Interpretation

Using Year 1 (A=100, B=111, C=122, D=133), what is the ratio A:D in simplest form?

- A. 133:100 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 133:100 does not follow the stated data. Divide 100:133 by gcd 1.
- B. 100:133 - CORRECT: Correct. Divide 100:133 by gcd 1.
- C. 200:266 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 200:266 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Divide 100:133 by gcd 1.
- D. 233:1 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 233:1 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Divide 100:133 by gcd 1.

Method / explanation: Divide 100:133 by gcd 1.

Trap: Preserve the requested A-to-D order.

Q63. Answer: C | Logical Reasoning

All valuers are registered. No person lacking that status may sign valuations. Which conclusion necessarily follows?

- A. Every registered person is one of the valuers. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Every registered person is one of the valuers. does not follow the stated data. All valuers possess the stated status, so none can simultaneously lack it.
- B. Some valuers lack that status. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Some valuers lack that status. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. All valuers possess the stated status, so none can simultaneously lack it.
- C. Every valuer is outside the class lacking that status. - CORRECT: Correct. All valuers possess the stated status, so none can simultaneously lack it.
- D. No registered person may sign valuations. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No registered person may sign valuations. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. All valuers possess the stated status, so none can simultaneously lack it.

Method / explanation: All valuers possess the stated status, so none can simultaneously lack it.

Trap: Do not reverse a universal proposition.

Q64. Answer: D | Logical Reasoning

If each letter is shifted forward by 4, how is INDIA coded?

- A. INDIA - INCORRECT: Incorrect: INDIA does not follow the stated data. Shift each letter independently by 4: INDIA -> MRHME.
- B. EMHRM - INCORRECT: Incorrect: EMHRM is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Shift each letter independently by 4: INDIA -> MRHME.
- C. JODJB - INCORRECT: Incorrect: JODJB ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Shift each letter independently by 4: INDIA -> MRHME.
- D. MRHME - CORRECT: Correct. Shift each letter independently by 4: INDIA -> MRHME.

Method / explanation: Shift each letter independently by 4: INDIA -> MRHME.

Trap: Do not reverse the word.

Q65. Answer: A | Logical Reasoning

Complete the series: 6, 8, 12, 18, ?

- A. 26 - CORRECT: Correct. Successive increments are 2, 4, 6 and 8; next term is 26.
- B. 25 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 25 does not follow the stated data. Successive increments are 2, 4, 6 and 8; next term is 26.
- C. 27 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 27 is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Successive increments are 2, 4, 6 and 8; next term is 26.
- D. 24 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 24 ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Successive increments are 2, 4, 6 and 8; next term is 26.

Method / explanation: Successive increments are 2, 4, 6 and 8; next term is 26.

Trap: Track differences, not ratios.

Q66. Answer: B | Logical Reasoning

Imran is the child of Fatima's only son. How is Imran related to Fatima?

- A. Child - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Child does not follow the stated data. The only son is the parent, so Imran is the elder's grandchild.
- B. Grandchild - CORRECT: Correct. The only son is the parent, so Imran is the elder's grandchild.
- C. Niece or nephew - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Niece or nephew is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The only son is the parent, so Imran is the elder's grandchild.
- D. Sibling - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Sibling ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The only son is the parent, so Imran is the elder's grandchild.

Method / explanation: The only son is the parent, so Imran is the elder's grandchild.

Trap: Resolve one relationship at a time.

Q67. Answer: C | Logical Reasoning

Some firms are exporters. All exporters are registered. Which conclusion follows?

- A. All firms are registered - INCORRECT: Incorrect: All firms are registered does not follow the stated data. The members of firms that are exporters inherit the property registered.
- B. No firms are registered - INCORRECT: Incorrect: No firms are registered is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The members of firms that are exporters inherit the property registered.
- C. Some firms are registered - CORRECT: Correct. The members of firms that are exporters inherit the property registered.
- D. Some registered are not exporters - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Some registered are not exporters ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The members of firms that are exporters inherit the property registered.

Method / explanation: The members of firms that are exporters inherit the property registered.

Trap: Do not universalise a particular premise.

Q68. Answer: D | Logical Reasoning

In a code, GOVERN is written as HPWFSO by shifting each letter forward once. How is COURT written?

- A. COURT - INCORRECT: Incorrect: COURT does not follow the stated data. Shift every letter of COURT forward once to obtain DPVSU.
- B. USVPD - INCORRECT: Incorrect: USVPD is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Shift every letter of COURT forward once to obtain DPVSU.
- C. AAAAA - INCORRECT: Incorrect: AAAAA ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Shift every letter of COURT forward once to obtain DPVSU.
- D. DPVSU - CORRECT: Correct. Shift every letter of COURT forward once to obtain DPVSU.

Method / explanation: Shift every letter of COURT forward once to obtain DPVSU.

Trap: Apply the same shift to every letter.

Q69. Answer: A | Arrangements

W, X, Y and Z sit in a row. W is left of X; Y is right of X; Z is left of W. Who is second from the left?

- A. W - CORRECT: Correct. The only order consistent with all relations is Z-W-X-Y.
- B. X - INCORRECT: Incorrect: X does not follow the stated data. The only order consistent with all relations is Z-W-X-Y.
- C. Y - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Y is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The only order consistent with all relations is Z-W-X-Y.
- D. Z - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Z ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The only order consistent with all relations is Z-W-X-Y.

Method / explanation: The only order consistent with all relations is Z-W-X-Y.

Trap: Build the full order before selecting a position.

Q70. Answer: B | Arrangements

Four tasks Survey, Design, Build and Inspect occur consecutively. Survey precedes Design; Build follows Design; Inspect precedes Survey. Which task is third?

A. Survey - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Survey does not follow the stated data. The forced order is Inspect-Survey-Design-Build, so Design is third.

B. Design - CORRECT: Correct. The forced order is Inspect-Survey-Design-Build, so Design is third.

C. Build - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Build is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The forced order is Inspect-Survey-Design-Build, so Design is third.

D. Inspect - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Inspect ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The forced order is Inspect-Survey-Design-Build, so Design is third.

Method / explanation: The forced order is Inspect-Survey-Design-Build, so Design is third.

Trap: Precedes means earlier, not immediately earlier unless stated.

Q71. Answer: C | Arrangements

Five persons stand by height. P is taller than R but shorter than T. V is shorter than R. X is taller than T. Who is tallest?

A. T - INCORRECT: Incorrect: T does not follow the stated data. The chain is $X > T > P > R > V$.

B. P - INCORRECT: Incorrect: P is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The chain is $X > T > P > R > V$.

C. X - CORRECT: Correct. The chain is $X > T > P > R > V$.

D. V - INCORRECT: Incorrect: V ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The chain is $X > T > P > R > V$.

Method / explanation: The chain is $X > T > P > R > V$.

Trap: Combine all comparisons into one chain.

Q72. Answer: D | Arrangements

Construction is after Tender but before Audit. Design is before Tender. Which is earliest?

A. Tender - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Tender does not follow the stated data. The order is Design, Tender, Construction, Audit.

B. Construction - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Construction is an intermediate, sign or operation error. The order is Design, Tender, Construction, Audit.

C. Audit - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Audit ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. The order is Design, Tender, Construction, Audit.

D. Design - CORRECT: Correct. The order is Design, Tender, Construction, Audit.

Method / explanation: The order is Design, Tender, Construction, Audit.

Trap: Translate every before/after relation consistently.

Q73. Answer: A | Directions

A person faces North and turns right 4 time(s), each by 90 degrees. Which direction is faced?

A. North - CORRECT: Correct. Each right turn advances one step clockwise; 4 turn(s) gives North.

B. East - INCORRECT: Incorrect: East does not follow the stated data. Each right turn advances one step clockwise; 4 turn(s) gives North.

C. South - INCORRECT: Incorrect: South is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Each right turn advances one step clockwise; 4 turn(s) gives North.

D. West - INCORRECT: Incorrect: West ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Each right turn advances one step clockwise; 4 turn(s) gives North.

Method / explanation: Each right turn advances one step clockwise; 4 turn(s) gives North.

Trap: Reduce turns modulo four.

Q74. Answer: B | Directions

A walker goes 12 km north and 16 km east. How far is the endpoint from the start?

A. 28 km - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 28 km does not follow the stated data. Displacement = $\sqrt{12^2 + 16^2} = 20$ km.

B. 20 km - CORRECT: Correct. Displacement = $\sqrt{12^2 + 16^2} = 20$ km.

C. 4 km - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 4 km is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Displacement = $\sqrt{12^2 + 16^2} = 20$ km.

D. 192 km - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 192 km ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Displacement = $\sqrt{12^2+16^2}=20$ km.

Method / explanation: Displacement = $\sqrt{12^2+16^2}=20$ km.

Trap: Distance walked and displacement differ.

Q75. Answer: C | Directions

A person starts facing North, turns left, then turns left again. Which direction is now faced?

A. North - INCORRECT: Incorrect: North does not follow the stated data. Two left turns reverse the starting direction, giving South.

B. East - INCORRECT: Incorrect: East is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Two left turns reverse the starting direction, giving South.

C. South - CORRECT: Correct. Two left turns reverse the starting direction, giving South.

D. West - INCORRECT: Incorrect: West ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Two left turns reverse the starting direction, giving South.

Method / explanation: Two left turns reverse the starting direction, giving South.

Trap: Track orientation after each turn.

Q76. Answer: D | Directions

A point B is 8 km south of A, and C is 8 km east of B. In which direction is C from A?

A. North-East - INCORRECT: Incorrect: North-East does not follow the stated data. Relative to A, C has positive east and negative north coordinates: south-east.

B. South-West - INCORRECT: Incorrect: South-West is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Relative to A, C has positive east and negative north coordinates: south-east.

C. North-West - INCORRECT: Incorrect: North-West ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Relative to A, C has positive east and negative north coordinates: south-east.

D. South-East - CORRECT: Correct. Relative to A, C has positive east and negative north coordinates: south-east.

Method / explanation: Relative to A, C has positive east and negative north coordinates: south-east.

Trap: Use a simple coordinate sketch.

Q77. Answer: A | Data Sufficiency

What is x? Statement 1: $x+6=16$. Statement 2: $2x=20$.

A. Each statement alone is sufficient. - CORRECT: Correct. Statement 1 gives $x=10$; statement 2 also gives $x=10$. Each alone is sufficient.

B. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. does not follow the stated data. Statement 1 gives $x=10$; statement 2 also gives $x=10$. Each alone is sufficient.

C. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Statement 1 gives $x=10$; statement 2 also gives $x=10$. Each alone is sufficient.

D. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Statement 1 gives $x=10$; statement 2 also gives $x=10$. Each alone is sufficient.

Method / explanation: Statement 1 gives $x=10$; statement 2 also gives $x=10$. Each alone is sufficient.

Trap: Test each statement separately before combining.

Q78. Answer: B | Data Sufficiency

What is the area of a rectangle? Statement 1: its length is 11 cm. Statement 2: its breadth is 8 cm.

A. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. does not follow the stated data. Area requires both length and breadth; neither statement alone is enough.

B. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient. - CORRECT: Correct. Area requires both length and breadth; neither statement alone is enough.

C. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Area requires both length and breadth; neither statement alone is enough.

D. Each statement alone is sufficient. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Each statement alone is sufficient. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Area requires both length and breadth; neither statement alone is enough.

Method / explanation: Area requires both length and breadth; neither statement alone is enough.

Trap: Do not import an unstated shape relation.

Q79. Answer: C | Data Sufficiency

Is integer n even? Statement 1: n is divisible by 20. Statement 2: n is divisible by 10.

A. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. does not follow the stated data. Either divisibility condition independently implies n is even.

B. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Either divisibility condition independently implies n is even.

C. Each statement alone is sufficient. - CORRECT: Correct. Either divisibility condition independently implies n is even.

D. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Either divisibility condition independently implies n is even.

Method / explanation: Either divisibility condition independently implies n is even.

Trap: Sufficiency does not require both statements to be equally strong.

Q80. Answer: D | Data Sufficiency

What is y ? Statement 1: y is positive. Statement 2: $y^2=100$.

A. Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 alone is sufficient, but statement 2 alone is not. does not follow the stated data. Statement 2 gives $y=\text{plus or minus } 10$; statement 1 selects $y=10$. Together they are sufficient.

B. Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 alone is sufficient, but statement 1 alone is not. is an intermediate, sign or operation error. Statement 2 gives $y=\text{plus or minus } 10$; statement 1 selects $y=10$. Together they are sufficient.

C. Each statement alone is sufficient. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Each statement alone is sufficient. ignores a condition or uses the wrong base. Statement 2 gives $y=\text{plus or minus } 10$; statement 1 selects $y=10$. Together they are sufficient.

D. Both statements together are sufficient, but neither alone is sufficient. - CORRECT: Correct. Statement 2 gives $y=\text{plus or minus } 10$; statement 1 selects $y=10$. Together they are sufficient.

Method / explanation: Statement 2 gives $y=\text{plus or minus } 10$; statement 1 selects $y=10$. Together they are sufficient.

Trap: A square equation has two real roots unless sign is fixed.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS